Interrogative Words

Interrogative words are used to ask **specific questions**. They help gather information about who, what, where, when, why, how, and how much/many.

Qui (Who)

Used to inquire about a **person** or **people**.

- **Qui** est-ce ? *(Who is it?)*
- **Qui** a gagné le match ? *(Who won the game?)*

Où (Where)

Used to ask about a **place** or **location**.

- **Où** habites-tu ? *(Where do you live?)*
- **Où** est la bibliothèque ? *(Where is the library?)*

Qu'est-ce que vs Que vs Quoi

These all mean "what", but are used in different structures:

Qu'est-ce que: Most common in spoken French. It **introduces a full question** with a subject and verb.

- **Qu'est-ce que** tu fais ? (What are you doing?)
- **Qu'est-ce que** c'est ? (What is it?)

Que: Used in formal or written French, **always used with inversion** (verb before subject).

- **Que** fais-tu ? (What are you doing?)
- **Que** veux-tu dire ? (What do you mean?)

Quoi: Used at the **end of a sentence** or **after a preposition**. Never used to start a sentence!

- Tu fais **quoi** ? (What are you doing?) – casual
- De **quoi** parles-tu ? (What are you talking about?)

Quand (When)

Used to inquire about the **time** or **when** an action occurred.

- **Quand** est-ce que tu pars en vacances ? *(When are you going on vacation?)*
- **Quand** est ton anniversaire ? *(When is your birthday?)*

Comment (How)

Used to ask about the **manner** or **way** something is done.

- **Comment** vas-tu ? *(How are you?)*
- **Comment** est-ce que tu fais ça ? *(How do you do that?)*

Combien (How many/How much)

Used to ask about **quantity** or **amount**.

- **Combien** de frères as-tu ? *(How many brothers do you have?)*
- **Combien** ça coûte ? *(How much does it cost?)*

Pourquoi (Why)

Used to ask about the **reason** or **cause**.

- **Pourquoi** pleures-tu ? *(Why are you crying?)*
- **Pourquoi** est-ce qu'il est parti si tôt ? *(Why did he leave so early?)*

À qui (To whom)

Used to ask about **possession** or to whom something is directed.

- **À qui** est ce livre ? *(Whose book is this?)*
- Tu parles **à qui** ? *(Who are you talking to?)*

De qui (About whom / From whom)

Used to ask about **someone related to the action** (often in passive constructions).

- **De qui** parlez-vous ? *(Whom are you talking about?)*
- **De qui** est cette lettre ? *(From whom is this letter?)*

Avec qui (With whom)

Used when asking about **company** or **companionship**.

- **Avec qui** vas-tu au cinéma ? *(Who are you going to the movies with?)*
- **Avec qui** dînes-tu ce soir ? *(Who are you having dinner with tonight?)*

À quoi (To what / What… for?)

Used to ask about the **object** or **purpose of an action**, especially with verbs followed by "**à**" (penser à, servir à, etc.).

- **À quoi** penses-tu ? *(What are you thinking about?)*
- **À quoi** ça sert ? *(What is it used for? / What's the point?)*

Lequel / Laquelle / Lesquels / Lesquelles (Which one[s])

Used when choosing from a known set of options. They agree in gender and number with the noun they replace or refer to.

Masculine: **Lequel**
Feminine: **Laquelle**
Masculine Plural: **Lesquels**
Feminine Plural: **Lesquelles**

These words often replace a noun and can stand alone or follow a preposition (à, de...).

- **Lequel** veux-tu ? *(Which one do you want?)*
- **Laquelle** de ces robes préfères-tu ? *(Which one of these dresses do you prefer?)*
- **Lesquels** as-tu choisis ? *(Which ones did you choose?)*
- **Lesquelles** sont à toi ? *(Which ones are yours?)*

